

Chapter 90_1 - Searching for Her

The demon clans outside looked at each other, but due to the appearance of the Emei Thorn, no one dared to step forward to challenge anymore. They could only watch helplessly as the woman withdrew her demonic weapon and turned to walk back into the demon cave.

Jiuying hid behind the great hall and peeked out, shaking her head and clapping her hands while watching: "Tsk tsk, I couldn't tell! When you act like a Demon Lord, you actually look quite convincing. Confess honestly—did you secretly practice before?"

"Practice makes perfect, that's all." Ning Fuyi smiled at her.

"Alright then." Jiuying shrugged, then her expression became serious. "The Demon Lords who came today are all weak in magical power, so you can still handle them. But what if those forces that occupy territories in the Demon Realm come looking for you later?"

"You've been so high-profile, showing off the Emei Thorn and claiming territory as king— isn't this too conspicuous?" Jiuying asked worriedly.

"This move is indeed risky." Ning Fuyi nodded. "But the Demon Realm is different from the outside world. Here, it's purely survival of the fittest. Look how many people came to our door looking for trouble when we first arrived among the demon clans—they just wanted to devour us."

"If I don't use the Emei Thorn to intimidate them in such a high-profile manner and claim territory, the troubles in the future will be endless. Then we'd continue hiding and living like fugitives, and we might very well be assassinated. Besides, what difference would that be from staying outside?"

"Only by making them fear the demon cave is the best way to protect ourselves." Ning Fuyi reached out and pulled down a piece of rotting black gauze curtain, turning it to ash. "Those demon clans that occupy territories are mostly strong on the outside but weak within, extremely concerned with face. In the short term, they shouldn't personally come to deal with me. As for the rest, you and I working together can handle them—kill one for each that comes."

"I now know that I have Ning Changfeng's power within me. I can take advantage of this time settling here to quickly refine and cultivate it, improving my cultivation level." As she spoke, the flame in her palm turned back into a rich pink light orb, swaying slowly with her fingers.

Jiuying nodded with half-understanding, puzzled: "How do you know the Demon Realm so well? It's as if this place is your home."

"Isn't it? These people are all old neighbors." Ning Fuyi pursed her lips.

"I don't believe it." Jiuying shook her head. "I think you're just making things up to fool me."

Since she didn't believe it herself, it wasn't that Ning Fuyi hadn't told her. Ning Fuyi continued smiling and contentedly watched the little flower fairies clean up the demon cave.

Actually, as Jun Molan's demon palace, this territory was extremely vast, equivalent to an entire Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate¹. It had all the necessary territorial divisions—library, study, sleeping chambers, side halls, everything one could want, and even a huge garden.

It's just that aside from Bone Beauty flowers², nothing else could grow in the Demon Realm, so this place was completely barren and used for storing miscellaneous items.

Ning Fuyi used this as the center point and spent three full days drawing Ning Changfeng's Boulder Array. The Boulder Array was embedded underground with immortal power, covering the entire demon cave. It was much more resilient than ordinary barriers and could keep the demon cave impregnable.

She also built a stone chamber in the center, creating a greenhouse for the little sprout. The room was bright and clean, filled with luminous pearls dug up from various parts of the demon cave, making the room as bright as daylight so the little sprout could grow well even in the Demon Realm.

She also set up barriers to block all demonic energy and brought in some other flowers from outside to plant beside the little sprout, so it wouldn't be lonely.

"Those who know would say you're settling down here, but those who don't might think you want to be a gardener in the Demon Realm." After the greenhouse was built, Jiuying walked in amazed, touching things as she went.

"So this is what you've been hammering away at these past few days—planting flowers here." Jiuying said with a smile, lowering her head to look at the little sprout that was growing vigorously.

"To grow the Divine Venerable back, you really are going to great lengths." Jiuying said as she reached out to touch it, but before her fingertip could reach the tender shoot, someone grabbed her wrist and pulled her arm back.

"You're blocking its light." Ning Fuyi said indifferently, pulling Jiuying to the door. Before Jiuying could get angry, she looked up and asked very seriously: "Do you want to cry?"

Jiuying was startled, then shook her head repeatedly: "I don't want to cry. What would it look like for a dignified divine beast to be crying?"

"Then go out." Ning Fuyi waved her slender fingers at her.

Jiuying didn't get to curse even once. She raised her orchid fingers³ to fiddle with her hair and pouted: "Fine. Here I've gone through life and death with you, but you only have that grass in your heart. You're someone who forgets righteousness at the sight of a sprout."

After saying this, she stomped away. Ning Fuyi wasn't angry either. She gently closed the door, pulled out a chair to sit at the table, and leaned on her arm to lie down, gazing at the tender green shoot that was fresh and vibrant under the light.

Having changed her appearance, her features were more sharp and severe, with prominent brow bones, a delicate nose bridge, and phoenix eyes that were deep blue in color. She didn't look like someone from the Central Plains⁴, and was even more aggressive-looking than before.

But when looking at the little sprout, the tenderness in her eyes remained unchanged.

When she brought her fingertip close, the little sprout, which had grown a bit taller, would wrap around her skin like green water plants or a winding snake—cool and clingy.

"Chu Qingqiu, if you had shown me even a third of this affection when you were human, how wonderful that would have been." She said softly, closing her eyes to feel the tender shoot touching her fingertip, imagining it as Chu Qingqiu's hand.

The same soft coolness, but with less indifference.

She pulled the glass cup into her embrace, took a deep breath, and as the fatigue of many days penetrated her entire body, her consciousness gradually blurred, and her words became nothing but murmurs.

"I'll wait here for you to come back. I won't go anywhere."

"When you return, I'll make sure you stay by my side. You won't be able to go anywhere!"

Footnotes:

¹ **Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate** (云际山门): The sect where the main characters come from, representing a standard large cultivation sect territory.

² **Bone Beauty** (骨中娇): A type of flower that can only grow in the Demon Realm, mentioned in previous chapters as having unique properties.

³ **Orchid fingers** (兰花指): A delicate hand gesture traditionally associated with feminine elegance in Chinese culture, where the fingers are curved gracefully like orchid petals.

⁴ **Central Plains** (中原): Refers to the central region of China, often used in cultivation novels to denote the main human territories as opposed to border regions or other realms.